

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦K

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣A

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠9

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥K

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 2
 ♥ 8 7 6
 ♦ Q J 2
 ♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ A Q 9 8 6 4

♥ 5 3

♦ 8 7 3

♣ 7 2



♠ 10 7
 ♥ K 10 9
 ♦ A K 10 5
 ♣ J 8 4 3

♠ K J 3

♥ A Q J 4 2

♦ 9 6 4

♣ A 5

SOUTH is unsure whether to bid game or not, so he bids 2NT to get more information about NORTH's hand.

NORTH's 3♠ is discouraging, a hand below average in strength and no outside high card.

SOUTH passes and hopes for the best.

West	North	East	South
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			
3♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ K			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 5

♥ 8

♦ 9 7 5 3

♣ K Q J 9 8 6 3

♠ Q 9 4

♥ 6 5 3

♦ Q J 6 2

♣ 10 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6 3

♥ A K Q J 7 4 2

♦ A 8

♣ 4

♠ K J 10 8 7 2

♥ 10 9

♦ K 10 4

♣ A 7

West

3 ♣

All Pass

4 ♥ by East

Lead: ♣ A

North

Pass

East

4 ♥

South

EAST has no way to tell whether WEST can provide one winner or not.

So she takes the bold approach and bids 4 ♥.

If the opening lead is a ♠ or a ♦ then EAST will probably make the game. Otherwise she will likely go down one.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8
 ♥ 5 4
 ♦ K 10 6 3
 ♣ A Q 7 5 2

♠ Q J 10 7 4 2

♥ K Q 7 2

♦ 5 2

♣ 9



♠ A 6 5
 ♥ 10 8
 ♦ J 9 8 4
 ♣ K J 10 3

♠ K 3

♥ A J 9 6 3

♦ A Q 7

♣ 8 6 4

Most good players have an extra restriction in their Weak Two-bid guidelines - they won't open with a Weak Two-bid when they hold an outside 4-card Major, even if the hand qualifies otherwise. This Deal shows why.

If NORTH opened with 2♠, SOUTH might well pass and a ♥ game would be missed.

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♠9			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 3
♥ A J 10
♦ K 7 5 4
♣ Q 10 4

♠ K J 9

♥ K Q 6 5

♦ 9 6

♣ A J 6 2



♠ 6 2

♥ 7 4 2

♦ A J 10 8 3 2

♣ K 7

♠ 10 8 7 5 4

♥ 9 8 3

♦ Q

♣ 9 8 5 3

WEST responds 2NT, asking for more information.

When EAST shows a decent hand with a high ♣
WEST should bid 3NT.*West**North**East**South*

2 ♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♥K